

Jobs To Be Done

The Jobs to Be Done framework takes a different approach than user personas. Instead of framing the customer by his attributes, this method helps teams study his goals and motivations. This tool was created to combat weaker user personas, and to help companies with a wide range of audiences that don't necessarily fit into effective, streamlined personas.

The Jobs to Be Done framework treats every solution, product, or feature as something that fulfills a job for the customer. For example, Facebook fulfills several jobs: it allows users to keep in touch with family, share their interests and actions, and read articles curated by friends.

This framework looks into what the user wants to achieve and how he is motivated when presented with a real life situation. It is heavily used in marketing to dig into the user's mindset when making a purchase. If a product hasn't been launched yet, it's helpful to dive into why your user might have chosen other current, subpar product solutions.

Job Stories

Job Stories are a way of framing the user's situation, motivation, and goal.

If your team is struggling to write good user stories, switching to job stories can help. By removing the solution from the story, teams can focus solely on the problem the customer is facing. This process stimulates an active conversation about different solution options, rather than getting stuck on one possibility.

When I am (in a situation),
I want to (motivation),
so I can (achieve an outcome).

Job Story Practice

Turn the user stories into job stories.

User Story	Job Story
1. As a Product Manager, I want a workshop on Jobs to Be Done, so that I can learn how to create better products.	
2. As a conference attendee, I want the schedule, so that I can know who is speaking when.	
3. As a Product Manager, I want a coach for our CMO, so that they can understand better work tactics.	
4. As a Facebook user, I want a better event feature, so that friends actually see my invitations.	
5. As a London tube rider, I want larger trains, so that I don't get squished.	